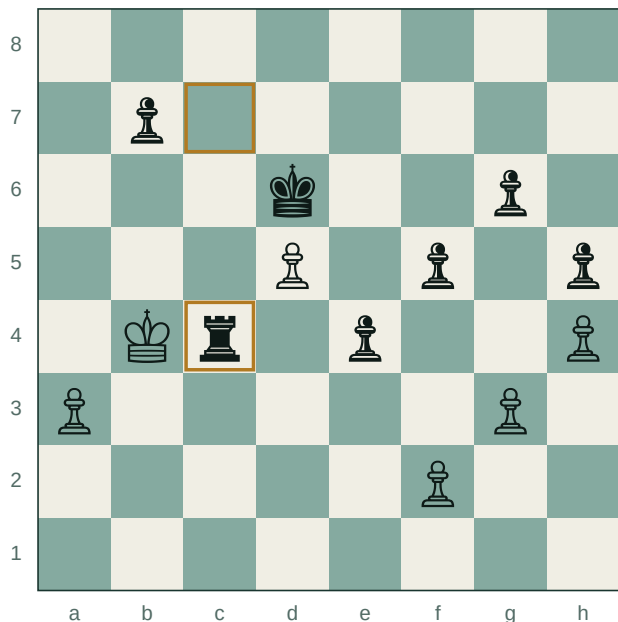


Active defensive resources: White, move 45

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 44...Rxc4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45. Kxc4 b6 46. a4

45.Kxc4 The king captures the rook on c4. Recorded reply: **45...b6**.

46.a4 The pawn moves from a3 to a4.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -5 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on d6. Geometrically undefended: rook on c4. Check for tactical protection.